

RVCE ACM STUDENT CHAPTER

in association with MochaTrade (YC S26)

ACM MARKETSPHERE 2026

Round 2: The Build Round

FROM CASE TO PROTOTYPE

In Round 1, teams pitched a strategic recommendation for their assigned track. In Round 2, each team builds a working software prototype that operationalizes that recommendation: the tool, dashboard, or simulator a real MochaTrade team would actually use to act on the team's thinking.

The prototype does not need to be production-grade. A functional demo that clearly shows the core input → decision/output flow, and that is visibly grounded in the team's own Round 1 recommendation, is what's being evaluated, not visual polish or lines of code. Teams should come ready to demo the tool live and explain how it reflects their strategic thinking.

Each track's build brief below lists what the prototype should do and the must-have features it needs to demonstrate. Teams are free to choose their own stack, scope features up within reason, and make reasonable assumptions where the brief doesn't specify, as long as those assumptions are stated when demoing.

1. Market Entry & Regulatory Strategy

Choosing where and how MochaTrade should go global next.

WHAT TO BUILD

A working “Market Entry Readiness” tool that takes a candidate country as input and returns a regulatory risk score, a recommended entry approach, and the compliance adjustments MochaTrade would need to make, turning the Round 1 recommendation into something a real ops or legal team could actually use.

MUST-HAVE FEATURES

- An input for selecting or entering a candidate market.
- A scoring or rubric view across the regulatory dimensions the team identified (e.g. derivatives rules, capital controls, KYC/AML).
- An output that ranks or compares multiple markets, consistent with the team's Round 1 sequencing.
- A clear surface for the key risks and mitigations tied to whichever market is selected.

EVALUATION WILL FOCUS ON

- How faithfully the prototype reflects the team's Round 1 regulatory reasoning
- Usability: could someone unfamiliar with the case use it to compare markets
- Whether the tool actually helps make an entry decision, not just displays information
- Technical execution given the time available

2. Growth & Monetization Strategy

Turning trust and access into sustainable trading volume.

WHAT TO BUILD

A working simulator or calculator for MochaTrade's growth funnel and monetization model — showing how changes to fees, growth-channel mix, and trust-building levers move projected trading volume and revenue over the first year.

MUST-HAVE FEATURES

- Adjustable inputs for pricing/fees and the growth mechanism from their Round 1 pitch, which shouldn't be purely paid acquisition.
- A live-updating projection (chart or numbers) that reacts to those inputs.
- Some visible representation of the trust-building plan (e.g. a funnel stage, a trust score, an onboarding flow).
- A way to compare at least two scenarios (e.g. baseline vs. the team's recommended approach).

EVALUATION WILL FOCUS ON

- Internal consistency of the model, do the numbers move the way the team's logic implies
- Whether trust-building is genuinely represented, not bolted on
- Clarity of the assumptions driving the projection
- Whether the tool would help someone actually decide on pricing and channels

3. The Flash-Crash Simulation

Surviving the first 60 minutes of a market meltdown.

WHAT TO BUILD

A real-time incident-response dashboard that a lean MochaTrade ops team could use during an actual flash crash, surfacing live signals (liquidations, support tickets, social sentiment), triggering the team's pre-drafted communications, and tracking what's been decided.

MUST-HAVE FEATURES

- A live or simulated feed of at least two signals (e.g. liquidation count, ticket volume).
- Alert thresholds or escalation triggers tied to that feed.
- Pre-built communication templates the tool can surface or send at the right moment.
- A running incident log or checklist capturing the decisions made (including on abnormal liquidations).

EVALUATION WILL FOCUS ON

- Speed and clarity of the tool under a simulated live scenario
- Whether it actually supports the incident response plan from Round 1, not just visualizes data
- Realism for a 3-person team operating under pressure
- Whether the design reduces chaos rather than adding another screen to watch

4. Build vs. Partner: The Infrastructure Dilemma

Rent the plumbing, or build it, and own the risk?

WHAT TO BUILD

A build-vs-partner decision tool that scores each core infrastructure component (wallet, UPI/banking rails, KYC/AML, trading engine) against the team's chosen criteria, produces a build/partner/hybrid recommendation, and lays out a rough phased roadmap.

MUST-HAVE FEATURES

- An editable scoring matrix with each infrastructure component as a row and the team's criteria as columns.

- Adjustable weights on the criteria, with the recommendation updating accordingly.
- A clear build/partner/hybrid output per component, with the reasoning visible.
- A simple phased roadmap or timeline view for anything the team recommends building in-house.

EVALUATION WILL FOCUS ON

- Whether the scoring logic matches the strategic reasoning from Round 1
- Clarity on what's core vs. non-core to MochaTrade's moat
- Realism of the resulting roadmap
- Whether the tool would help a real ops team make and defend the call

5. Founding a Category vs. Fighting Incumbents

Is MochaTrade a new market, or a crowded one in disguise?

WHAT TO BUILD

An interactive positioning tool, a competitive map that places MochaTrade against domestic brokers, crypto exchanges, and grey-market workarounds on the team's chosen axes, paired with a messaging generator that produces sample launch copy from the chosen positioning.

MUST-HAVE FEATURES

- A competitive map or quadrant with at least three named competitors plus MochaTrade, on axes the team defines.
- An editable positioning statement that drives the rest of the tool.
- Auto-generated or templated sample copy (headline, tagline, or short pitch) based on that positioning.
- A way to toggle between at least two framings (e.g. “new category” vs. “safe, legal alternative”) and see the messaging change.

EVALUATION WILL FOCUS ON

- Sharpness and defensibility of the positioning the tool encodes
- Whether the generated messaging is coherent and on-strategy, not generic
- Depth of the competitive landscape represented
- Whether the tool makes the moat argument more convincing, not just prettier

6. Hiring the Next Ten

Three founders built the product. Who builds the company?

WHAT TO BUILD

An interactive hiring and runway planner that sequences the next 10 hires against MochaTrade's priorities and a pre-seed budget, and visualizes the resulting team and burn over the next 12 months.

MUST-HAVE FEATURES

- An input for starting budget/runway and monthly burn.
- The ability to add roles with a cost and a start month, in the team's recommended sequence.
- An auto-updating view of the remaining runway as hires are added.
- A way to mark a role as FTE, contractor, agency, or fractional, and see the budget impact of that choice.

EVALUATION WILL FOCUS ON

- Whether the sequencing logic matches the priorities argued in Round 1

- Realism of the budget math against a pre-seed runway
- Thoughtfulness of the build-vs-contract toggle
- Whether the resulting team picture is coherent and legible at a glance

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ALL THE BEST!